

APPLIED AI DELIVERY | OPERATING TRANSFORMATION | HIGH-RELIABILITY LEADERSHIP

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania | 412.287.8640 | russelldudek@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/russelldudek
https://russelldudek.github.io/AIAction/

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Operator-technologist with 20+ years leading complex technical operations, high-reliability engineering, AI-first transformation, and customer-backward delivery. Builds mechanisms that connect emerging technology to real workflows, quality and evaluation, human authority, adoption, and measurable operating outcomes. Experienced leading cross-functional teams, translating between executives and technical specialists, and carrying ambiguous work through implementation.

Applied AI portfolio Use-case framing, prioritization, workflow design, RAG and agent patterns, human-in-the-loop controls	Delivery assurance Quality systems, evaluation, standard work, risk escalation, process controls, accountable ownership	Adoption and value Training, demos, coaching, visual management, operating cadence, performance and value signals
--	---	---

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Vape-Jet - Director of Operations2025-Present

Software-enabled robotics | Operations, quality, customer delivery, enterprise systems

- Lead an AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success and support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connect factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Translate technical and operating constraints across leadership, engineering, production, support, sales, and customers; own outcomes through implementation rather than stopping at recommendations.
- Use field experience from approximately 1,000 deployed robots to strengthen feedback loops, issue visibility, service learning, and operating decisions.

DudeWorth - Founder / AI and Automation Advisor2017-Present

Applied AI, workflow design, readiness, governance, automation

- Developed AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks spanning business value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Designed agentic workflow patterns combining structured context, retrieval, LLMs, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advised on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, AMRs, ASRS, cobots, transportation systems, network analysis, and workflow design.
- Teach complex AI concepts through practical operating models that make decisions, authority, evidence, and adoption requirements visible.

Amazon - Operations Management / Site Leader2014-2018

Prime and Prime Now launch and scaled operations

- Helped launch and lead the Pittsburgh Prime operation, a 24/7 customer-delivery system supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines for labor planning, throughput visibility, standard work, escalation, and continuous improvement using Lean and Gemba disciplines.
- Served on the Prime Now with Whole Foods launch team and contributed customer-backward thinking to emerging delivery concepts, including geolocation-based proof of delivery.

Compunetics - Director of Operations and Engineering Management

2000-2013

High-reliability engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery

- Progressed through R&D program management, production leadership, strategic acquisition work, operations, and director-level responsibility.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, root-cause analysis, process control, and customer delivery across complex technical programs.
- Built quality systems, standard work, measures, and cross-functional problem-solving mechanisms in a high-reliability environment.
- Collaborated with demanding technical stakeholders including the U.S. Department of Defense, CERN, Intel, and AMD; contributed publications, talks, and HyperTransport Consortium work.

Cardinal Building Products - Regional Director

2021-2023

- Established the company's first remote regional operating model and modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, and online-buying workflows.
- Connected sales, service, operations, and logistics data to improve visibility and customer execution across a distributed territory.

ZeusVu - Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations

2018-2022

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real estate, and restricted-airspace use cases with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed concepts for computer vision, inventory detection, mapping, and medical chain-of-custody workflows, preserving clear human authority and compliance boundaries.

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh
Bachelor of Science
Scientific grounding includes materials science, physical chemistry, and biology studies.

CREDENTIALS

- Google AI Essentials
- IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
- Six Sigma Certification
- OSHA 10
- Food Safety Management Certification

TECHNICAL AND OPERATING TOOLKIT

Agentic AI; LLM workflows; retrieval-augmented generation patterns; human-in-the-loop design; evaluation and governance concepts; Python; SQL; JavaScript; TensorFlow; Tableau; Odoo; Jira; Confluence; HubSpot; Slack; GIS.

LEADERSHIP FIT FOR APPLIED AI

- Leads teams through ambiguity with clear expectations, cadence, coaching, and escalation.
- Surfaces root workflow problems before prescribing technology.
- Connects quality, governance, knowledge, adoption, and economics to delivery.
- Communicates technical subjects in operating and business language.
- Preserves evidence boundaries; does not confuse a concept with a production deployment.

RELEVANT OPERATING MECHANISMS

- Opportunity intake:** business and client outcome, feasibility, data and knowledge readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
 - Workflow assurance:** structured context, retrieval, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
 - Portfolio leadership:** visible priorities, named ownership, cross-functional cadence, blockers, stop decisions, and measurable next actions.
- Adoption system:** standard work, training, demos, coaching, feedback, support, and continuous learning.
 - Build-versus-buy lens:** workflow fit, quality, security, integration, supportability, dependency, operating cost, and exit path.
 - Executive communication:** translate technical complexity into decisions, risk, operating value, and accountable action.

SELECTED ROLE THESIS

Build the common law of AI-enabled work. Treat every workflow as a fact pattern that must earn a clear record, retained human authority, evaluation evidence, adoption ownership, value proof, and an explicit scope for reuse.